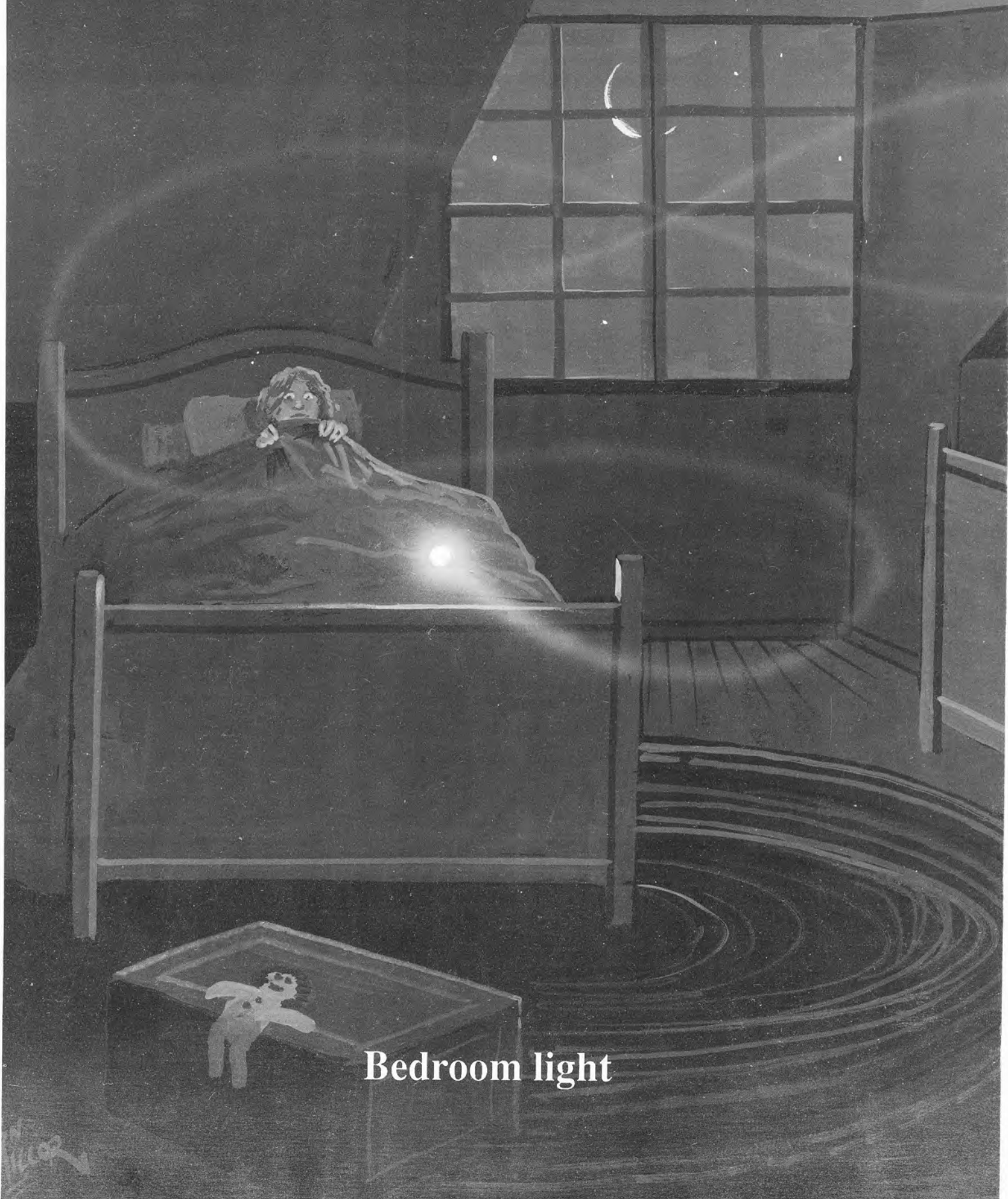




Bedroom light

INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER

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EDITORIAL

Ill breeze

No UFO event — or alleged UFO event — in years has stirred such heated debate as the story coming out of Gulf Breeze, Florida, where since last November a man whom some (though not we) call “Mr. Ed”—as if he were a talking horse—has taken numerous pictures of what some (though not we) believe to be spaceships.

In April CUFOS released a special bulletin (sent to all who receive *IUR*) in which president and scientific director Mark Rodeghier and investigator coordinator Robert D. Boyd concluded the case is “most probably a hoax” and cited their reasons for skepticism. The considerable majority of CUFOS associates who wrote us supported our position, some saying they had been waiting for someone to express the doubts they felt instinctively on viewing photographs so implausible-looking as to make Adamski’s and Meier’s seem credible by comparison.

In granting the pictures’ beyond-the-boggle-threshold appearance, Gulf Breeze supporters have only conceded the obvious. But their contention that real UFO photographs might well look unreal gets no historical support from such well-documented — and credible-looking — real UFO photographs as those taken at McMinnville, Oregon, and Trindade Island. History tells us that pictures that look fake (as well as, of course, some that don’t) *are* fake. If Ed’s are authentic, they’re a first in UFO history.

Ed, however, is not the first man in history to produce numerous pictures of alleged UFOs which did not resemble the UFOs other people all over the world have been reporting over the past four decades. George Adamski, the first great contactee trickster, took repeated photographs of a “Venusian scoutcraft” which his followers were hard-pressed to find represented in the mass of “normal” (noncontactee-generated) sightings. As we know from long familiarity with the UFO phenomenon, UFOs have a simple, uncomplicated, uncluttered appearance; the typical UFO is a structured disc without markings or protrusions. It does not resemble, in other words, something that you use to cover a lightbulb with — which is what the Gulf Breeze object looks uncannily like.

As I was discussing this and other matters with a longtime friend and colleague for whom I have great respect, he suggested (albeit not entirely seriously) that the radical deviation from familiar patterns of UFO behavior might have to do with the appearance on the scene of a new set of alien visitors, with their own idiosyncratic ways of doing things. My immediate response, of course, was to say that if something like this is even to be considered, we must have far better evidence than we have seen so far (the evidence so far consisting of unconfirmed anecdotes and unlikely photos from Ed and his family,



Jerome Clark

an essentially meaningless “lie-detector test” [it takes no more than Valium to beat a polygraph examination] and raw, undocumented sightings by area witnesses of what may or may not be UFOs, whose relevance to Ed’s alleged experiences is uncertain at best). Later, however, it occurred to me that maybe this group of aliens is cleverly concealing its presence by flying ships that, when photographed, look like small models.

Any explanation is possible if we throw common sense out the window and caution to the breeze, as the principal MUFON investigators did not hesitate to do at the first available opportunity. Within three weeks of Ed’s surfacing, they were telling the local press that the object being photographed was an “unknown of great significance.” One of them has acknowledged that he regards UFOs as divine messengers — “God’s missionaries and their associates.” He is certainly entitled to his beliefs (even if, from a purely objective reading of the UFO evidence, there is no basis whatever for such a conclusion), but someone who holds a religious interpretation of UFOs should not be investigating them for an organization that claims to have a scientific orientation. As one well-known ufologist remarked to me in a letter, this “may be entirely relevant to the way [Gulf Breeze] was handled” — which was badly, in his estimation.

It is essential that ufologists have as keen a sense of what they do *not* believe as what they do believe. Everything is not equally deserving of being taken seriously. Most of you know that, of course, if we can judge from the mail you send us; from it we have developed a high regard for our readers, few of whom fit the stereotype of the UFO-believer-as-wild-eyed-goofball.

But even serious researchers need occasionally to be reminded that because ufology aspires to be a scientific enterprise, it must conduct itself accordingly. The progress of science is a long history of debate, criticism and outspoken expression of difference of opinion. CUFOS would be neglecting its scientific responsibility if it kept silent after concluding, from careful study and reflection, that colleagues and friends are badly mistaken. And we expect our colleagues and friends to speak out when they think we’ve goofed. Yet some of those

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UFOs in Washington skies

by Donald A. Johnson

Donald A. Johnson, Ph.D., is a research psychologist and UFO investigator who lives in Kirkland, Washington.

Dan MacIndoe, 32, of Oak Harbor, Washington, is an ex-Navy lieutenant with seven years' military experience. During that time he worked in aviation supply and also served with the Blue Angel air show committee. He is familiar with most types of military aircraft.

On Thursday, January 21, 1988, MacIndoe's 72-year-old mother was visiting him at home on the northwest side of Whidbey Island, about four miles south of Deception Pass and five miles north of Whidbey Naval Air Station. Around 8:00 P.M. the mother stepped outside to smoke a cigarette.

An object among the stars in the south-southeast sky caught her attention and after watching it for a short while she alerted her son, his wife, his young daughter and his in-laws.

To MacIndoe's eye the object looked something like an H-3 helicopter in the distance, starlike with red and blue flashes. As subsequent investigation would reveal, however, it was neither a helicopter nor a UFO; it was a star, either Sirius or Rigel. Both bodies were in that position of the sky at the time of the sighting.

The witnesses, still not knowing what they were seeing, observed the object intermittently over the next two hours. Occasionally clouds would obscure it from view. MacIndoe and his family last saw it around 10 o'clock. As MacIndoe told me, it was a "curiosity but nothing dramatic due to the distance and size."

At 10:45 his mother went outside again for another smoke. MacIndoe tells what happened next:

She immediately called for me to come outside in a distressed voice. I, my wife, three-year-old daughter, and my wife's father all ran out on the front porch and my wife's mother observed through the window.

Our observations over the next 25-30 seconds are as follows and we all agree on the following description:

We saw a ball of light yellowish/white in color and in the same position or relationship to the trees as the object sighted earlier in the evening but now much closer and lower in the sky. I estimate the glowing object was 1 1/2 to two miles from our home to the southwest, placing it at the south side of Dugualla Bay Flats. I estimate its elevation to be 100 feet above tree level. Within two to three seconds the object moved from a stationary position.

The bright ball of light took off vertically at a terrific high rate of speed, from a dead start to perhaps 1000-1500 feet up and immediately changed direction from vertical to lateral. My mother exclaimed, "Here it comes!" as the light moved directly at us and covered a distance of 1 1/2 miles in approximately three seconds. As it approached our house it seemed to slow, taking approxi-

mately 15 seconds to slowly drift directly overhead and disappear from view as it went to the northeast. We lost sight as our view became blocked by our roof. We were standing on the front porch.

I viewed the object from the time it reached its vertical position to the time it disappeared behind the house through a telephoto camera lens. I took my eyes away from the camera when the object was straight above our position, thus viewing the object both through my camera lens and with the naked eye. As it moved to an overhead position the bright ball of light was no longer visible as if it were turned off.

[When] directly overhead, [the] object [was a] perfect circle. We determined the shape from the light pattern now clearly visible.

The lights were bluish-white in nature and I estimate 15 lights spanned the circumference of the circle. All remained on, forming a circle of "running lights." The lights would pulse brighter in sequence, I believe going in a clockwise direction. I could not make out the body of the craft and the circular description is based on the light pattern only.

During the event winds were calm. There were scattered clouds in the vicinity. We live in a rural area. There were no sounds. During the entire episode none of us heard the usual prop or jet noise associated with military aircraft using the airfield. At the time the object was directly overhead, I asked my family for complete silence to listen for engine noise. There was absolute silence. . . .

Our family ran into the house after the object disappeared over the rooftop. We were all visibly shaken but not terrified. We began to compare notes on what each of us saw and agreed on the description I have provided.

At approximately 2255 [10:45 P.M.] I called NAS [Naval Air Station] Whidbey's weather office and inquired if there were any unusual lights sighted. The answer was no, but a log entry was made on my report by the forecast duty officer.

I next called NAS Whidbey's duty office and again made the same inquiry. Again I was told there were no sightings reported. The duty petty officer took my name and number.

The third and final phone call was made to my older brother Doug in California. I had a strong urge or need to talk to someone who I know would take me seriously. I knew Doug took UFO sightings seriously, having himself believed to have made a sighting in the desert years ago. This conversation concluded and our family again recounted the events and compared notes. We went to bed at approximately 2330 [11:30], all of us feeling uneasy. . . .

I awakened Friday morning at approximately 6:30, having suffered a nightmare which involved a craft above our house which bathed the house in light. I had a feeling of terror. We were all awake by 7:00 A.M. and comparing notes once again. We went over the events again and again, leaving no doubt among us that we all saw the same thing.

At approximately 8:00 A.M. I called NAS operations to ask if they had any lights in the area at 2245 the night before. I was told by the duty chief that all flight operations were secured at 2230. Our sighting was at 2245 and the object was in NAS Whidbey's restricted air space. When [it was] sighted above the tree level approximately 1 1/2 miles from our house, I would estimate the object was within 200 yards of the eastern end of NAS Whidbey's runway.

I hesitated to make the next call but felt a strong need to find someone else who at least might have seen the bright light. I called the local radio station in Oak Harbor and talked to Dur Roberson, the radio deejay. At first I cautiously asked if anyone had phoned or verified our sighting. The answer was no. I then told our story. He made a tape and put it on the air and I hoped it would draw out someone else who had seen the light over Dugualla Bay. Within minutes I was besieged with calls from Seattle radio and TV shows. I granted interviews with them in the hopes the increased exposure would put us in contact with someone who viewed the object.

MacIndoe received a call from a Fidalgo Island couple who

claimed they heard an unusually loud noise at 10:45. They did not go outside to determine its source, however. A caller from Camano Island said he had seen "unusual" lights the evening before, but from his description it appears these were merely aircraft lights.

Radio and television stations got a handful of calls from others who said they had seen unidentified objects that evening.

In the course of my investigation I checked with the National Weather Service station at Sandpoint and learned that all NWS balloons are released at 3:00 P.M. and 3:00 A.M. Pacific Time, for reporting an hour later to coincide with midnight and noon GMT. The balloons are released from Quillayute (near Forks, Washington) and Salem, Oregon. Thus there could have been no NWS balloons in the area at the time.

The object MacIndoe and his family observed is an unknown.

A week later MacIndoe got a call from another Oak Harbor resident, Jerry Lang. MacIndoe referred him to the UFO Reporting Center, which brought his report to the attention of investigator Don Olson and me. Lang gave this account:

On midnight of the 27th (or Thursday morning, January 28th) I was heading home down my driveway when I saw these four lights off to the right of Ika Island. There was three orange lights and a red light. I saw the lights to the right of the island, over the mouth of the [north fork of the] Skagit River [near the town of La Conner, Washington]. I thought, well, the Indians fish in the river for steelhead — gill-netting — and I thought it must be somebody was missing and the Navy was out looking for them in a helicopter. So I hopped out of the car and ran in the house and grabbed my binoculars.

I could see it was no helicopter and I could have heard it if it was because the next night one came by, and I could hear it from here to there. So then I put the spotting scope [45x] on it and I couldn't see very good within because it was very fuzzy, but I didn't think about it. So I just grabbed my binoculars and started looking and I thought, well, maybe there are some houses there I don't know about. But I knew there were no houses in that direction.

I watched for 10-15 minutes. The orange lights got brighter and dimmer while the red light stayed pretty much the same. I thought, "Well, that sure is odd," and I kept trying to figure it out. I could also see a little bit of white light out of the bottom of it, like it was shining [a beam of light] down. I sat here watching the lights and it never did move.

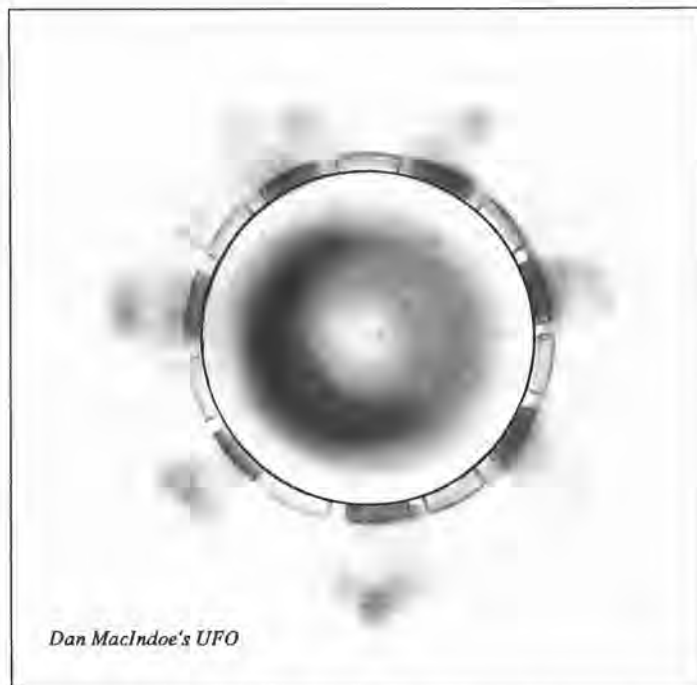
He had the impression that all of the lights were part of the same object.

All of a sudden a "strobe light" flashed on top of the thing. Five to 10 seconds later a single light appeared to the left. Off to the left, where the little hill is in there, up about half as high as Ika Island. The light just appeared. I didn't see it go over there; it just appeared there.

It started getting brighter and dimmer. It got real bright and turned perfectly round, just like a fish egg or a balloon, and had a glow, a little halo all the way around it. Then the light got dimmer and started toward the ground and became more disc-shaped as it went down.

The object could have changed its orientation to the witness to "edge on" or the change in shape could have been the result of atmospheric conditions.

It went down to the ground. I watched for another five to 10 minutes, when two lights appeared over the land, at about the same height in the sky, three-



Dan MacIndoe's UFO

quarters the height of Ika Island. Both lights turned perfectly round like an orange ball with halos. Then they started down to the ground, becoming disc-shaped about halfway down to the ground. One went clear to the ground; the other I could see the light of in the treetops of a bushy area.

So they both disappeared from view. Meanwhile that big thing always stayed there on the right with the three orange lights and one red light on it. Another 10 minutes or so went by, while these lights on the one remaining object continued getting brighter and dimmer. A strobe light flashed again and within 20-30 seconds started getting very bright — like the sun. I could see the right end of the object illuminated by the light and it looked just like that [sketch, which shows half of a small oval on top of half of a larger oval]. The light glowed for maybe 30-40 seconds and went out. As the light got dimmer, there was a dull afterglow in the area, like the afterglow you get from a TV screen after you turn off the set.

I sat for another half hour watching it. By this time it was getting to be about 1:50 A.M. and the dull-glowing light was still there but it wasn't doing anything, so I decided to go to bed. I set the alarm to go off at 3:00 A.M. to check on it. I woke up at 2:45 A.M. before the alarm went off and [I] looked and it was gone.

I had the feeling that when the strobe light went off and five seconds later when the other two lights appeared that something came out of that big thing and went over there. Maybe when the strobe light flashed one more time they came off the ground and went back in it or something. I saw three objects total. The one on the right was much bigger than the two on the left. They appeared to be round balls as big as hot-air balloons [through binoculars]. The distance across [from Whidbey Island] to there is 1 1/2 to two miles to that flat area over the river there. I knew there shouldn't be any houses there.

The next thing I thought was that maybe there was a fire up on the foothills. When I got up the next morning, the first thing I did was use the spotting scope to look all over that hillside and there hadn't been anything burning over there.

So I called MacIndoe because I'd read the newspaper article about his sighting [Whidbey News Times, January 27] and that's what he said he saw — a round orange ball. So what I saw must have been the same deal.

I've got an airplane up in Anacortes. I'm a private pilot. Three to four days later I flew my plane from Anacortes on a bearing from my home right over the spot. There are a few little cabins there by the river and a couple of farms back in there behind La Conner. Other than that there is nothing in there.

The MacIndoe and Lang sightings were only two of a

number from the state of Washington between January and April of this year. A brief summary follows:

January 20, Edmonds, night: A woman saw an ice-cream-cone-shaped object for a few seconds before it winked out. A neighbor reportedly saw it for several minutes but refuses to discuss it because of her religious beliefs.

January 21, Oak Harbor, 11:00 P.M.: A Navy enlisted man noticed a bright light in his rear-view mirror. When he turned to look, the light shot past him. His car engine stalled on the next turn. Since then the car has stalled frequently and the car has malfunctioned in other ways.

February 29, Seattle and Bangor, 6:25 P.M.: Hundreds of persons called television stations and the UFO Reporting Center to recount sighting a green fireball which streaked across the sky from north to south. Reports were received from as far south as southern Oregon.

February 29, Orting, 7:30 P.M.: A 17-year-old high-school student made a one-hour videotape of the planet Venus, which she mistook for a UFO. The videotape was later broadcast on KIRO-TV.

March 3, Seattle, evening: Police and KMPS radio station received reports of balls of light observed over Green Lake.

March 5, West Seattle, 9:30 P.M.: A couple observed a huge (225-300-foot) metallic object hovering 300 yards over the West Seattle golf course. It rocked back and forth in a "falling leaf" motion, then shot off straight up. Five blocks away another witness reported bowling-ball-shaped lights zipping up and down the street.

March 12, West Seattle, 1:55 A.M.: A witness observed a plate-shaped UFO with three lights, red, green and violet, move in an erratic zigzag, up-down motion over Elliot Bay off Duawamish Head for two to three minutes.

March 13, South Seattle, 3:30 P.M.: A distant black object was observed by a witness who was driving north on I-5.

March 21, Pavallup, 3:45 A.M.: A diamond-shaped UFO with a lighted opening was observed by four witnesses at treetop level at a distance of 300 feet. It was seen for 20 seconds.

April 4, South Seattle, 9:00 P.M.: A woman driving north on South Rainier Avenue noticed three small white dots of light over Lake Washington in a triangular formation. They shot off in different directions. Two miles north, at Rainier Beach, she saw a gigantic object shaped like the Goodyear Blimp hovering over a house to her left. It was dark gray with black lines coming up from underneath. It had red, blue and flashing white lights. A second witness north on Rainier Avenue reported seeing what may have been the same object with a diamond-shaped lighting pattern. Both witnesses reported the UFO shot off to the west.

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Coral E. Lorenzen (1925-1988); APRO (1952-1988)

With the passing of Coral Lorenzen on April 12, 1988, and the subsequent shutting-down of the Aerial Phenomena Research Organization, which she and her late husband Jim founded, an era of UFO history closes.

Mrs. Lorenzen, who had been suffering ill health for some time, died at the age of 63 of respiratory failure. Her daughter Leslie had preceded her in death only weeks before.

Coral Lightner's interest in strange objects in the sky began in 1934, when as a nine-year-old Wisconsin schoolgirl she saw a white hemisphere-shaped object cross the western sky from south to north in an undulating trajectory. Three years later, after she related her experience to the family doctor, he loaned her the books of Charles Fort and she learned that other people had seen similarly unusual phenomena.

On September 29, 1943, she married Leslie James Lorenzen and four years later, in Douglas, Arizona, on June 10, 1947, saw her second UFO: a tiny luminous sphere which rose from the ground and vanished into the night sky. Not many persons can claim two UFO sightings even before Kenneth Arnold's experience made "flying saucers" a household word, but Mrs. Lorenzen could.

Fascinated by all this, she kept in contact with a wide range of individuals who shared her interest. In January 1952, while living in Sturgeon Bay, Wisconsin, she formed APRO and soon was publishing the *APRO Bulletin*, which for the next two decades would be essential reading for anyone looking for a comprehensive, intelligent guide to worldwide UFO activity.

Eventually the Lorenzens relocated to the Southwest and in due course settled in Tucson. In 1964 Jim Lorenzen became director and Coral assumed the position of secretary-treasurer.

APRO was shaped by Mrs. Lorenzen's strong personality. She — and the organization — were early champions of reports involving occupants, 20 years before Dr. Hynek coined the phrase "close encounters of the third kind," which they insisted were not to be confused with the tales told by flamboyant hucksters who said they were hobnobbing with Venusians and Clarionites. Other early UFO investigators were reluctant to embrace humanoid reports — which to them seemed excessively exotic — but in time APRO's open-mindedness was vindicated. People who made these reports, as even Blue Book spokesmen would acknowledge on occasion, proved to be no different from other UFO witnesses; they were normal, sane, puzzled and sincere.

APRO collected these and other reports not only from the United States but from South America, where the organization was ably represented by such notable investigators as Dr. Olavo Fontes in Brazil and Horacio Gonzales in Venezuela. Through

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Abduction states of consciousness

by Robert E. Bartholomew and
Keith Basterfield

Robert E. Bartholomew, an American pursuing graduate studies at the Flinders University of South Australia, is working on a Ph.D. thesis on the sociology of UFO beliefs. Keith Basterfield is a leading Australian ufologist.

Although much has already been published on the topic of Whitley Strieber's best-selling book *Communion* (1987), we feel another hypothesis needs to be aired. It is our hypothesis that Strieber is susceptible to altered states of consciousness (ASCs), possessing what Barber and Wilson (1981) describe as a "fantasy-prone personality." We suspect this hypothesis could potentially explain a number of prominent UFO-abduction claims.

Consider the encounter (typical in his life history) that inspired Strieber to write *Communion*. On the night of December 26, 1985, while asleep with his wife in an isolated cabin in Ulster County, New York, he recounted the following events:

...I abruptly found myself awake.... I heard a peculiar whooshing, swirling noise coming from the living room downstairs.... I sat up in bed, shocked and very curious. I settled back in bed.... Over the course of this narrative this sort of inappropriate response will be repeated many times.... The reaction is very different from what one would think.

No sooner had I settled back than I noticed that one of the double doors...was moving closed.... I sat up again. My mind was sharp. I was not asleep, nor in any hypnopompic state between sleep and waking. I wish to be clear that I felt, at that moment, wide awake and in full possession of all my faculties....

Then I saw edging around it [the door] a compact figure. It was so distinct.... I simply sat there staring, too stunned to move.

The next thing I knew, the figure came rushing into the room. I recall only blackness after that....

Strieber's bedroom encounter with a 3 1/2-foot-tall entity is not uncommon in the annals of the supernatural. An illustrative example from a survey of apparitional accounts compiled by Green and McCreery (1975,71) is remarkably similar to Strieber's encounter:

...I was sleeping in a back bedroom...and I woke extremely suddenly to see a hospital nurse sitting in my bed. The room was totally dark but the figure was totally colored, and was entirely real, as if in daylight. She was perfectly "friendly" and smiled, and I noticed she had a gold filling in a tooth on the side nearest to me. I was absolutely terrified—my heart seemed to stop and then thump...[After hiding, then glancing up I saw] the figure was still there! After that I remembered nothing—"blacked out" as they say.

English psychologist Stan Gooch, in his book *The Para-*

normal (Gooch, 1978, 73), describes a number of similar personal experiences on the wake/sleep interface while "waking abruptly."

Invariably the experience is preceded by my sitting upright in bed having, for some reason, awakened abruptly. On one such occasion, I opened my eyes to see a large snake coiled on the bed. I grabbed for it, but in the act of my reaching out the snake disappeared. Much more often my hallucinations are human figures. I am now fairly used to them—but once or twice the figure has persisted long enough for me to believe that I am, this time, fully awake and that the apparition is really there.

Although typically characterized as slidlike projections and fleeting images of faces and objects mimicking reality, there are abundant examples of subjects' experiencing hypnagogic and hypnopompic images (auditory and/or visual visions on the awake/sleep interface) that are indistinguishable from reality. McKellar (1968) provides an example of just how real these images can appear.

A young couple had a routine in which the wife made breakfast for her husband and then saw him off to work. One morning she recalled leaving bed, washing, dressing, making breakfast, then kissing her husband good-bye. At this point she woke up, still in bed with her husband beside her. Accounts in pages 21, 140, 155, 159 and 172 appear to describe hypnagogic/hypnopompic imagery, while events on pages 24, 127 and 172 could well be this phenomenon combined with sleep paralysis. Such phenomena can occur to normal healthy people at times (Richardson, 1969).

In addition to experiencing periodic vivid visions on the awake/asleep interface, Strieber's life history is filled with examples of events characteristic of chronic bouts of spontaneous ASCs and/or a "fantasy-prone personality." Among other examples, there is an apparent out-of-body experience on page 214, a fuguelike flight to Europe (p. 136), and "the image" (p. 164) which is remarkably similar to the chronic apparitional perceptions of "Ruth" investigated by psychiatrist Morton Schatzman (1980).

Ludwig (1966) has detailed 10 general characteristics of ASCs. Among these are: (1) alterations in thinking—subjective disturbances in concentration, attention, memory and judgment; (2) disturbed time sense; (3) fear of loss of grip on reality; (4) changes in emotional response; (5) changes in body image "and a profound sense of depersonalization"; (6) perceptual disturbances such as hallucinations and increased imagery. Looking at *Communion*, we find:

(1) "...the extreme strangeness of what I was hearing did not arouse me to action," p. 21

"...I could not sustain enough attention to work for more than five to 10 minutes..." p. 35

"...I decided that I couldn't live a moment longer in New York." p. 49

(2) Disturbed time sense features on pp. 131, 134, 135, 136, 143, 147 (we will outline these in more detail later).

(3) "I thought that I had lost my mind." p. 35

(4) "I became hypersensitive, easily confused..." p. 33

"Wave after wave of sorrow passed over me." p. 40

"I felt suddenly and absolutely afraid. It was exactly as if the sky were a living thing, and it was watching me." p. 50

(5) Depersonalization seems to occur:

"'Whitley' ceased to exist." p. 26

"I had the feeling of being separated from myself, as if either I was unreal or the world around me was unreal." P. 33

and perceived body image:

"like I turn into another kind of person. I'm big, I'm heavy, I'm dark, I'm bony." p. 155

(6) Heightened clarity of environment is suggested on pages 21, 140, 155, 159, 164, 172 and 215.

Throughout the book Strieber makes no attempt to hide the fact that he has been haunted by a lifelong "secret terror" which has caused him great puzzlement. In the book it is strongly implied that this terror is the episodes suggestive of ASCs and fugue states. Let's examine two incidents in detail.

First, while attending the University of Texas in late August 1967, Strieber experienced episodes of "missing time" lasting "at least 24 hours." He tells of an entire day of slidelike recollections of activities punctuated by periods of no conscious memory. A few weeks later he left the United States and went to Europe, ending up in London. "I returned to London in an odd way, [four] weeks later than I planned, with no way to explain these weeks. I cannot say how I got back. What I do know is that I found myself outside a hotel at six in the morning."

Just prior to leaving for Europe, Strieber tells of being "obsessed with the notion of getting away from the University of Texas, out of the United States, of going wherever I could, as far away as possible." He told friends his reason for leaving was the 1966 Charles Whitman sniping incident on campus in which numerous people were killed and wounded. In *Communion* he confesses that the real reason was his "secret terror" of lifelong bizarre experiences and blackouts. Strieber's flight without valid reason, his almost complete lack of memory for

six weeks, carrying on life as normal, with vague recollections during this period "a jumbled mess," are suggestive of a fugue state. Numerous episodes of missing time and memory blackouts are scattered throughout the book (see pp. 134-140 for several consecutive examples).

Strieber appears sincere and genuinely puzzled by his experiences. He had attained fame and financial success through several best-selling imaginative novels prior to *Communion*. Since then he has set up a group to explore other reported abductions, having received hundreds of letters from people reporting similar experiences.

There seem to us to be an entire class of what psychologists would classify as normal, healthy individuals who are prone to experiencing a variety of ASCs, without conscious intent to deceive. This group perceive ASCs—fugues, transient memory losses, road hypnosis, amnesias, lucid dreams, out-of-body experiences and imaginary companions—within the context of their supernatural world-view. Wilson and Barber (1983) have taken the forefront in this area. From preliminary research by Hilgard (1970, 1979) and Barber and Wilson (1981, 1983), it seems that approximately four percent of the population may fall under the category of the "fantasy-prone personality." Barber and Wilson (1983, 345) administered a battery of tests and interviews on 27 "excellent" and 25 "nonexcellent" female hypnotic subjects with a mean age of 28. Their results have far-reaching implications for not only many UFO-abduction reports, but Old World fairy encounters, religious visions, out-of-body experiences and perceptions of apparitions, especially alleged percipients who chronically report such phenomena. Although their results are tentative and need replication, Barber and Wilson (1983, 350) found that most fantasy-prone subjects (92 percent) estimated they spend half of their working day fantasizing, compared to 0 in the control group.

In discussing the vividness of their experiences, Barber and Wilson (1983) found that the fantasy-prone "typically 'see,' 'hear,' 'smell,' and 'feel' what is being described" in conversations or on TV. Sixty-five percent of the fantasizers reported that their fantasies were "as real as real" (as hallucinatory) in all sense modalities, and experienced in an "automatic" or "involuntary" manner (compared to 0 in the control group):

They see sights equally well with their eyes opened or closed. Also, imagined aromas are sensed, imagined sounds are heard, and imagined tactile sensations are felt as convincingly as those produced by actual stimuli (352).

...almost all of the fantasy-prone subjects have vivid sexual fantasies that they experience "as real as real" with all the sights, sounds, smells, emotions, feelings, and physical sensations...[and] are so realistic that 75 percent of the fantasizers report that they have orgasms produced solely by sexual fantasies. (This surprising occurrence was also reported by one subject in the comparison group.) (351)

Further comparisons between fantasy-prone and non-fantasy-prone individuals are striking relative to the UFO experience. For instance, UFO-abduction percipients occasionally claim to have had a psychic history, complete with out-of-

body experiences, religious visions, and apparitional and healing experiences. Relationships were found by Barber and Wilson (1983) with fantasy-prone personalities in each of these categories. For example, while 92 percent of the fantasy-prone subjects studied "see themselves as psychic or sensitive and report numerous telepathic and precognitive experiences," just 16 percent of the comparison group reported such experiences (359). Further, 88 percent of the fantasy group (compared to eight percent in comparison subjects) reported "realistic out-of-body experiences" (360). Fifty-percent of fantasizers (eight percent in the control group) reported automatic writing by a guiding "spirit or a higher intelligence" (361).

Fifty-eight percent of the fantasy-prone subjects (eight percent in the control group) reported spending a "large part" of their childhood playing/interacting with fantasized people or animals (so-called imaginary companions):

...they report having clearly seen, heard and felt them in the same way that they perceived living people and animals (346).

As children, all but one of the fantasy-prone subjects lived in a make-believe world "much or most of the time." Those playing with dolls or toy animals (80 percent) believed them to be living, with unique feelings and personalities. While "invisible playmates" are common in children and in recent years have been viewed as a sign of mental health and creativeness (for a discussion of this, see Pines, 1978, 38-42, 106), there were significant differences between the fantasy-prone and control groups:

Many of the 25 subjects in the comparison group also pretended their dolls or stuffed animals were alive; however, with three exceptions, they did so only when they were playing with them. Although they made believe that the dolls and toy animals had personalities and said and did specific things, the make-believe play was always confined to a specific period and the toys did not seem to have an independent life (Barber and Wilson, 1983, 346).

While most, perhaps all, children play make-believe games, it is uncommon for them to continue with imaginary companions into adulthood. But even when they grow up, the extensiveness and vividness of the fantasy-prone group "has not significantly decreased."

The content in *Communion* suggests to us that Strieber (a designer of fantasy games and a fantasy writer) may be within this four percent. If true, he should be an excellent hypnotic subject, which is true of only 20 percent of the general population (Hall and Grant, 1976, 42). Not surprisingly, Dr. Donald Klein, Director of Research at the New York State Psychiatric Institute, after examining Strieber, described him in *Communion* as "an excellent hypnotic subject." Further, in line with Barber and Wilson's fantasy-prone subjects, Strieber should score high in tests designed to measure imagination, creativity and fantasy (Lynn and Rhue, 1986). This would appear likely given his ability to write vividly detailed science-fiction novels. We would also predict that as a child he had an "imaginary companion." Further, that fantasy interactions with his

companion or companions were not routinely confined to specific play periods and possessed independent fantasized lives. It is hoped in the future that he may be amenable to the testing of this hypothesis.

Based on Barber and Wilson's preliminary findings and a review of 16 detailed and well-publicized alleged UFO-abduction accounts (Bartholomew, 1987), we think it worthwhile to pursue the hypothesis that many abduction-prone individuals (in instances where the percipient is not apparently hoaxing or suffering from what is traditionally viewed as mental illness) will rate favorably in possessing fantasy-prone personalities. Bartholomew (1987) found that when the degree of hypnotic susceptibility in 16 abductees was mentioned in the literature, in every instance the primary subject was rated as a very good or exceptional hypnotic subject. Although yet to be tested on a significant sample of UFO abductees by examining their life histories and personality characteristics, this area appears promising. Consider the following three options by leading UFO researchers in this regard. The first is by psychiatrist Berthold Schwarz (1979, 127):

In my experience UFO contactees, unlike most across-the-board psychiatric patients or so-called healthy people, have been usually easy to hypnotize or almost always go rapidly into deep somnambulistic trances.

UFO author and investigator Ann Druffel (1977, 21, 277) has observed that her experience coincides with that of Dr. William McCall (practicing California family doctor) who has regressed numerous UFO-abduction percipients and found reluctance on the part of the other witness or witnesses "seems to be part of a peculiar pattern." Druffel continues:

Time and time again in various cases, a primary witness will be easily regressed, giving a vivid and full account of the experience; any corroborating witness to the same case will either resist hypnosis altogether or prove a very poor trance subject.

The significance of the work by Hilgard (1970, 1979) and Barber and Wilson (1981, 1983) cannot be overemphasized in attempting to understand the psychological basis of many contemporary UFO abductions and related experiences within a historical context. In order to test our hypothesis we suggest that researchers administer standardized tests designed to measure hypnotic susceptibility, personality and creativity/fantasy of abductees. We would not be surprised if a substantial number possessed characteristics of a fantasy-prone personality.

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Coming in IUR...

MJ-12: the failure of the critics' case,
by Stanton T. Friedman

UFOs in science fiction,
by Chris Rutkowski

Gulf Breeze: a note to the skeptical

by Dennis Stacy

Dennis Stacy is editor of the *MUFON UFO Journal*.

The special *CUFOS Bulletin* on the Gulf Breeze, Florida, photographic case falls with all the subtlety of a thundering hatchet. Can it really be that nothing in the field has warranted a special bulletin of its own within the last seven years, not MJ-12, not the surprising crest of popularity ridden by *Communion*, or even, for that matter, the smaller wave set in motion by *Intruders*? Surely all three subsume claims of an equal, if not more fantastic and startling nature, than those propounded by the individual known to most only as "Ed," the central figure in the Gulf Breeze episode.

Perhaps things have been more moribund than I first thought. Or perhaps it is the presence of the pictures themselves that raises the red flag response of hoax.

Regardless, certain aspects of the *Bulletin* demand comment, inasmuch they show signs of having been composed and rushed into print without much pause for reflection. That aside, let me say I come neither to praise nor to bury the main witness—I wasn't there when alleged events took place—and so have no way of knowing absolutely if they transpired as claimed or not. Nor am I the least interested in fomenting what can be construed in any way as a controversy between MUFON and CUFOS on the matter.

Nonetheless the *Bulletin* presents some assumptions in such simplistic fashion that they cry for correction. To begin with: "Almost every experienced ufologist, upon first viewing the color images, has said something like, 'These photos are too hokey to be real.'" Certainly your readers would never know from this generalization that Bruce Maccabee and Budd Hopkins, to name but two, think otherwise. Nor would your readers know that Robert Nathan of the Jet Propulsion Laboratory has reportedly refuted his first newspaper quote, i.e., that the photos were obviously a hoax. Much is also made of the *National Enquirer's* refusal to run the pictures. But no one mentions that the *Enquirer's* first rights option ran out on March 1, as it was awaiting a report from Nathan. As far as I know, ufology is still awaiting a preliminary report from him, despite promptings from some who originally supplied him with material.

The *Bulletin's* authors also say, "And it is still possible that, despite the use of a Polaroid camera, the witness has developed an ingenious means of creating double exposures." No special ingenuity is needed; Maccabee has already demon-

strated that simple double exposures *can* be taken with the original older Polaroid model in question. But at least one video film has also been taken, along with a series of images (of a different object) on 35mm film in a sealed Nimslo camera provided by an outside party. The two dozen or more pictures taken are reported as if each one were taken on a separate occasion, but this is not the case, either. Five were taken of one sighting and 10 of another; thus 15 pictures account for *two* sightings. I'm not "happy" with the sheer number of sightings and photographs myself; unlike the *Bulletin's* authors, however, I'm willing to withhold judgment for a little longer at least. Adducing the thousands of sightings of the Hudson Valley UFO(s) against Gulf Breeze is an equally prejudicial case of comparing oranges to apples. Those sightings occurred over a time span of *years*. (And, indeed, one might ask why *better* pictures weren't taken, given the opportunity?) Other people *have* reported and photographed the Gulf Breeze UFO, or something similar, unless two separate sets of photographs, one submitted anonymously, are attributed to Ed as well.

Dave Barry's article for the *Miami Herald* Sunday supplement *Tropic* is *almost* adduced as if Barry had won a Pulitzer for investigative reporting. In fact, he did win a Pulitzer recently—for his nationally syndicated humor column, characterized by capital type and exclamation marks (and cynicism that borders on the vicious). His accompanying staff photographer may or may not have been experienced with Polaroid cameras and film, but in general such personnel are veteran Nikon 35mm users. The fact that Ed employed 80 ASA film admittedly seems significant and may yet turn out to be so. But old Polaroids are customarily wide-angle, fixed lenses, which means they readily accommodate slow shutter speeds in comparison to standard and telephoto 35mm lenses. The photographer's remarks sound like the kiss of death, but may or may not be. The trouble is that photoanalysis is a sophisticated business and not served well by abrupt assumptions and generalizations. Movement on the film plane, among other things, is a product of distance. Additionally, you can easily obtain a sharp picture in low light if the field of view is large enough in comparison to shutter speed.

Mention is also made of Ed's reporting a smell of cinnamon, which is tied to Whitley Strieber's having reported the same in *Communion*. The *Bulletin* observes, "The coincidence is intriguing because nowhere else in the UFO literature can we find a mention of cinnamon...." Yet in the April 1988 issue of the *MUFON UFO Journal*, one of two issues referenced by the *Bulletin's* authors because it contains an article on the Gulf Breeze case, Jenny Randles notes (p. 13), "An hysteri-

cal woman claimed to be kidnapped from her bed by figures with leathery skins that smelt of cinnamon." She suggests, however, that the hysterical woman was influenced by the showing in England of Fallon's abduction in *Dynasty*!

The truth, of course, is that the entire field is contaminated by previous reports, and abduction reports particularly so because of the vast publicity given both *Communion* and *Intruders*. It is an unfortunate fact of ufology we are going to have to live with, however, else we'll be reduced to drawing up lists of prohibited smells (finite, after all, or rather the human interpretations of same), with proscribed visual descriptions sure to follow. The point is: Similarities used to be routinely adduced in support of a case, unless, of course, one has a predisposition otherwise. In short, they can be used according to what the individual ufologist is trying to prove, in the same way that blowing on your hands either warms them up or cools them off, depending on the ambient temperature and circumstances.

Ed's statement about pulling off the "Ultimate Prank" (did he really speak in Capitals?) is another piece of evidence that can be taken in two ways, depending which way the prevailing wind blows. According to Walt Andrus, the statement was made in an entirely different context and referred to a prank that might be pulled involving the high school band of which Ed's son is a member. The informant who told CUFO's investigator and *Bulletin* coauthor Robert Boyd about the remark, by the way, is also alleged to have committed acts of vandalism against Ed's family and to have been confronted by the father. In short, his statement may well be as suspicious and potentially personally motivated as Ed's is presumed to have been.

Other aspects of the case have simply been omitted altogether, one presumes because of the rush to print the *Bulletin*. For instance, there is the matter of the "classical" landing-trace circle of bare ground found in the schoolyard, which correlates with one of the photographs of a hovering object. There is the fact that Ed himself is pictured in a recent sequence of pictures taken by his wife. This can mean the pictures are real, as alleged, that Ed snapped the shots himself with a remote-control device attached to the camera, or that his wife is also involved in an elaborate hoax.

In fact, it is this elaborateness that seems to bother *Bulletin* authors most, not only in regard to the case under discussion but in future consideration of similar, if such there are, cases, as well, again as if a percipient were to be allowed only a certain number of assigned sightings and no more. Indeed, a certain parochial chauvinism informs the whole article and disregards the pre-existing literature, discounting, for example, that there might be any sort of strategy behind the phenomenon (Dear-dorff and others) or that the phenomenon itself might be capable of perpetrating a "hoax" (Vallee).

But let us consider that Gulf Breeze is an outright human hoax. Then surely it is one of the first water, involving not only the prime photographer and witness but his wife and two children, the editor and staff of the weekly *Sentinel*, and some

20-odd other witnesses who have allegedly reported recent UFO sightings, including the anonymous "Believer Bill" (who submitted a separate set of prints) and the mother and father of the *Sentinel*'s editor. Said hoaxers, in the course of same, have also faked Polaroid, 35mm and video pictures, and a round "landing" circle which conspicuously confirms to the measurements and diameter of one of the photographed objects.

It is just conceivable that this is indeed the case. It is also conceivable that something highly strange is going on in Gulf Breeze, although nothing inherently stranger than what has been reported numerous other times by numerous other people in numerous other places.

I find it highly premature, then, for CUFO's to say that it "expects this statement to be both the first and last one we make on Gulf Breeze." Since the case is ongoing, why not wait until all the available evidence is in before assigning events there the finality of the Ultimate Prank? Few things in life are ultimately final, and that probably includes death and taxes. Certainly it includes Gulf Breeze and UFOs.

Coral Lorenzen — *continued from page 6*

Fontes' and Gonzales' reports in the *APRO Bulletin*, North American ufologists learned of such seminal cases as the Venezuelan humanoid encounters of December 1954, the Trindade Island photographs, the Itaipu Fort "attack" and others.

Unlike Maj. Donald Keyhoe, who headed the other major organization of the 1950s, the National Investigations Committee on Aerial Phenomena (NICAP), Mrs. Lorenzen discounted theories of an official cover-up and criticized NICAP's attempts to force Congressional hearings on alleged UFO secrecy. She thought ufology was better served by concentrating on investigation and documentation of cases and making the subject palatable to scientists. *APRO* did a fine job of both.

Alone or with her husband Mrs. Lorenzen wrote *The Great Flying Saucer Hoax* (1962; an expanded 1966 paperback version was luridly retitled [by the publisher] *Flying Saucers — The Startling Evidence of the Invasion from Outer Space*); *Flying Saucer Occupants* (1967); *UFOs Over the Americas* (1968); *UFOs — The Whole Story* (1969); *The Shadow of the Unknown* (1970); *Encounters With UFO Occupants* (1976); and *Abducted!* (1977).

In a position statement published in Ronald D. Story's *The Encyclopedia of UFOs* (1980), she characterized the extraterrestrial hypothesis as the "most sensible" explanation for the reports. "There are probably several races of intelligent beings in our galaxy alone who have solved the problem of propulsion which would make visitation to this planet very possible," she said. "The thousands of reports of UFOs in the sky, on the ground, and accompanied by humanoid but alien-appearing occupants indicate that a careful, methodical and in-depth study of Earth and its inhabitants is underway."

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Gulf Breeze: a note to the committed

by Mark Rodeghier

Mark Rodeghier is president and scientific director of CUFOS.

Dennis Stacy and I agree on one point: the *CUFOS Bulletin* was not our first and last word on the Gulf Breeze affair. Would that we were so lucky.

I find it odd that Stacy has been designated (I presume) by MUFON to write a critique of the CUFOS position on Gulf Breeze. Stacy has had no active involvement with the case and is not a member of the MUFON investigative team. Surely Donald Ware, Charles Flannigan, or Bruce Maccabee would have been a better choice because of greater familiarity with the evidence.

The MUFON investigators would also have been better choices because, unlike Stacy, they have been stating publicly for months that the Gulf Breeze events are true UFOs. It is time to put an end to the canard that CUFOS, by publishing the *Bulletin*, was "premature" in its evaluation of the Gulf Breeze case. We published our statement in part because of the irresponsible claims being made by the MUFON team.

For example, on February 25, 1988, the *Gulf Breeze Sentinel* quotes Ware: "There are repeated, apparently staged photographic sessions. I mean, somebody up there wants somebody down here to take these photographs; for what reason I'm not sure...the photographs show an unknown of great significance because of the quality of the photographs and the reputation of the independent witnesses."

That same month, on WEAR-TV, Budd Hopkins remarked, "I feel that there is absolutely no sign of a hoax; that the photographs are genuine; that the witnesses are telling the truth and that this presents probably the best—without any doubt the best—photographic evidence in 40 years of UFO investigation."

Is there any doubt as to what was being claimed without qualification—and not even in specialized UFO journals but in the popular press? As we read such claims over a period of several months, we at CUFOS grew increasingly uneasy. Given the information we would eventually publish in the *Bulletin* concerning the negative aspects of the Gulf Breeze affair, we found it inconceivable that responsible investigators would speak so boldly about a case which was ongoing and still under active investigation. And so, after much soul-searching, we acted, but hardly prematurely. The *Bulletin* was an attempt

to balance the premature *positive* information disseminated by the investigators.

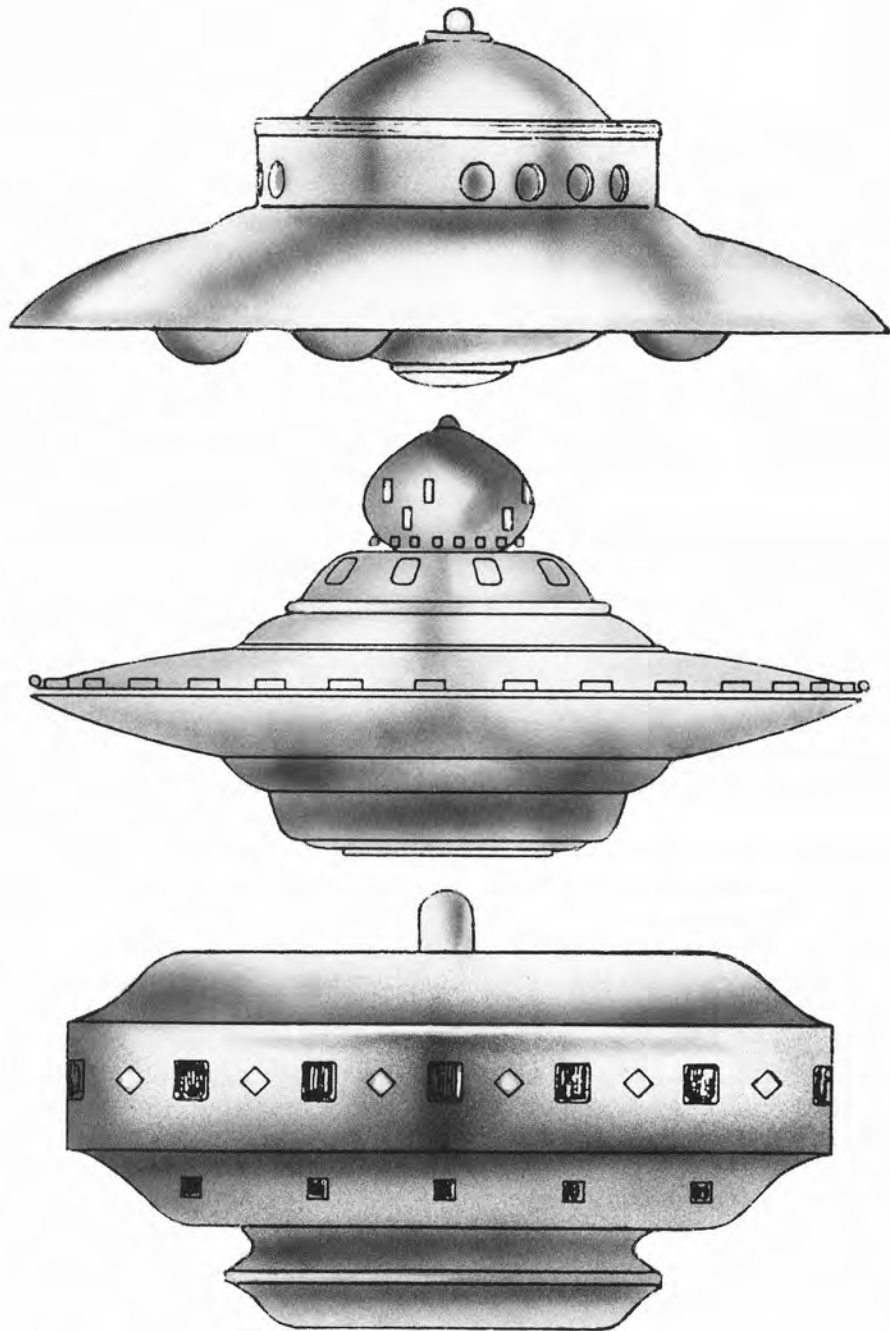
The MUFON team broke an important rule of investigative technique in the Gulf Breeze affair: Do not publicize an investigation or its preliminary results too early; usually more harm is done than good. It is true that Ed's story was in the papers, so some public acknowledgement of the investigation was inevitable. But there was no reason to go whole-hog, so to speak, and to provide continual claims and statements which realistically could not be supported.

An excellent example of how to handle an investigation is included, ironically, in the May 1988 issue of the *MUFON UFO Journal*. Walter Webb, longtime investigator from New England, describes his 10-year study of an abduction case involving two witnesses who never discussed their experience after it occurred. He has not been talking about the case publicly because, presumably, his investigation was ongoing and he did not want to make claims he could not yet support or to bias the witnesses. Moreover, the case is quite complex, and he has written a book-length manuscript to describe the work he and his colleagues have done. The Gulf Breeze affair is similarly complex—probably more so, in fact—and just as potentially sensational. But the tactics of the investigators were the opposite of those chosen by Webb.

At this point it would behoove all of us to wait for a full report by the MUFON team and, especially, the all-important photoanalysis being done by Bruce Maccabee. Our readers should be aware, though, that in a recent conversation Robert Nathan of the Jet Propulsion Laboratory confirmed that he (1) was not doing independent investigation of the Gulf Breeze photos and (2) still believed them to be bogus. He asked me to state that he supports Maccabee's study of the photos and does not want to become embroiled in any CUFOS/MUFON dispute. I heartily endorse that sentiment. Other competent UFO researchers with whom we at CUFOS have spoken since the *Bulletin* was published have continued to agree that the photos look faked upon first inspection. Moreover, independent analysis by Willy Smith and Robert Boyd has discovered several discrepancies between the witness testimony and the photos themselves. For example, the first five photographs could not have been taken in the time frame claimed by Ed, as has been admitted by the MUFON team in the May issue of the *MUFON UFO Journal*.

A telling illustration of the reasoning of the Gulf Breeze investigators is supplied by Stacy when he writes, "Other people have reported and photographed the Gulf Breeze UFO,

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Three disputed "UFOs": From top to bottom, George Adamski's Venusian scoutcraft, Billy Meier's Pleiadean beamship and "Ed's" Gulf Breeze "unknown of great significance."

Bedroom light

by I. Scott

I. Scott, Ph.D., is a physiologist at the Ohio State University Medical School.

In a recent article (*MUFON UFO Journal*, February 1988) Jenny Randles mentions "the presence of small balls of light, often seen in the bedroom whilst the abductee is a child" as a recurrent feature in British abductions. Although we do not live in the British Isles, one such experience happened to my sister and me.

The observation took place near the Fourth of July 1949-51 (my best guess would be 1951) at 6844 Bale Kenyon Road, Galena, Ohio, between 9:00 and 11:00 P.M. My sister Sue Postle and I had beds on opposite sides of an upstairs attic room and normally retired around eight o'clock. Our parents usually remained in the living room reading and sometimes listening to the radio. Because we lived on a farm and had no TV and our parents carefully selected our radio and magazine exposure, my sister and I had not heard of UFOs then and I do not know whether my parents had.

I don't remember that anything unusual happened before the event. It was dark and I had fallen asleep, then slowly awakened to see a small (around 5-20mm) glowing object flying around in the room. In color and appearance, it resembled incandescent metal such as one would find in a blacksmith's shop.

The object slowly circled the room in a meandering motion. The walls on the east and west sides of the attic room slanted toward the ceiling. The object weaved vertically and laterally as it slowly circled the room. Then I realized that its path appeared to show guidance. Although the room was dark, I was familiar with its shape and knew where the walls and furniture were. In the object's meandering as it circled the room, it never bumped into anything. It always turned before it got to a wall or other object. I do not recall seeing it reverse and I believe it always moved forward. It flew slowly and, as I remember, it circled the room about three times. Several times it came quite close to me. It did not change its shape, brightness, or size.

I thought that Sue was asleep, so I didn't say anything to her. After I had watched it for between two to six minutes, it flew (as I recall in a straight line from the south end of the room) to the chandelier, which was in the center of the ceiling and was turned off at a wall switch. Without touching or feeling this lamp or any of the walls, it circled the chandelier in the area between the chandelier and the walls. When it did this

it no longer meandered but made a tight circle. It stayed several inches away from the chandelier's periphery and circled in the same place a number of times (25-30 perhaps). Next it slowly spiraled downward. It spiraled in perfect geometric fashion with the spiral becoming smaller as its altitude decreased. When it had spiraled so that it was directly below the center of the chandelier, it made a noise and I saw lights coming from it. I concluded that it had exploded.

At this point I was terrified and ran down the stairs. When I reached the stairs, I bumped into Sue, who also was running out of the room. We collided and fell down the stairs and then bumped into the closed door at the bottom. We finally opened the door and ran screaming to our parents. They did not believe us. I remember that my father threatened to paddle us if we did not go back upstairs. We were too terrified to enter the room again and just stood there. Then my mother sympathized with us and asked my father to look in the room. So far as we remember, he didn't find anything. I do not recall that anything unusual happened afterwards.

The next morning Sue, my mother and I discussed the incident. I thought I remembered that Sue said she watched the object move around outside the window for a while as if it were looking in and then it came right through the window. When I asked her about it later (1984), she said that she woke up and first saw it in the room.

I asked my family about this incident in 1984 and obtained my sister's recollections:

"This happened when I was somewhere around six to nine years old. I was born in 1944. It was summer. My sister and I slept in the same room in different beds. It was probably around 9:00 - 11:00. I had been asleep or nearly so and I became aware of a bright little light flying around the room, not at all like a lightning bug — much bigger and moving differently. I watched it, I suppose trying to figure out what it was, and then I realized my sister was watching it too. We became afraid and both ran downstairs to Mom and Dad as fast as we could. They were still awake, as I remember, and thought we were nuts.

"Years later my mother said Irena had probably been telling scary stories and we just got scared and imagined it, but I'm sure that wasn't true, because I had been asleep and it just wasn't something I imagined. I remember most of all being scared. I saw the object circle the lamp, but didn't see it change its appearance or make a noise. It was the color of an ordinary light bulb and as big as a ping pong ball. It was yellowish white."

My mother's recollections were: "My recollection of this

occurrence is quite faint as it happened several years ago. My husband and I were reading after Irena and Sue had gone to bed. All of a sudden the girls hit the closed stairway door and both of them bolted into the room screaming. They said something came into the window and a light traveled around the room two or three times (as I remember) and then it disappeared. They were scared and watched it until it disappeared and they ran downstairs. They were very frightened and we had no explanation for it."

The event must have left quite an impression because several other relatives still remember it. For example, a cousin recalled that he was afraid to stay in that room by himself.

Because my parents still live in this house, I was able to investigate further. I do not know how the object entered the room. The room had one window which was screened and two doors. The door to the downstairs was closed and the other one just opened into another room with a screened window. There were no holes in the screens.

In comparison to a firefly, the object was on continuously for several minutes, had a color different from a firefly's, and did not move up and down in the pattern of a lightning bug. There are no swamps in the vicinity, so there would be no reason to suspect it to have been swamp gas.

One inorganic source is ball lightning. As I recall, however, the night was clear. For one reason, we all remember that it was. For another, we had old trees near the house and if my mother even thought it might storm, she kept us downstairs. Since my parents made us return to the room, I'm sure the weather was clear. Thus I do not believe that the object was associated with an electrical storm.

It showed a complex, guided trajectory. It responded to its surroundings at a distance without touching them and it acted as if it were aware of the size and the shape of the room. It did not guide itself along electric wires or walls. There were wires at the top of the ceiling going from a wall switch to the chandelier and then to another chandelier in the next room (under wallpaper and plaster). The chandelier in our room was turned off at the wall switch. The object did not follow these wires. Also, there were wires along the walls for wall sockets and the object did not follow any of these wires.

The object meandered while avoiding the walls and the furniture and it did not "guide" itself along anything. Even taking into account new theories, such as fifth and sixth forces and antimatter, there is no basis that I know of to hypothesize that the objects in the room would produce an effect (the object's deflection), because the object moved close to or away from the walls, furniture, and me as I turned at foot and inch distances, but it did not collide with anything. There have been no electrical problems in the room in the years since. The object gave no evidence of a propulsive system, such as when it flew to the chandelier and circled. It did not leave a trail and made no noise as it flew.

I probably watched the object for several minutes. Sue

became aware of my watching it and, thus, may have watched it for a longer period of time than I did. We don't know how long it had been in the room before we awakened. We also cannot explain why we ran from the room at approximately the same time.

A brief description of this observation was also published in the *Ohio Journal of Science* 87(1) 24-26, 1987.

Abduction states — continued from page 9

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CETI:

communicating effectively with terrestrial intelligence

by Chris Rutkowski

Chris Rutkowski, an *IUR* contributing editor, works as a curator at the University of Manitoba library. He is editor of *Swamp Gas Journal*.

Flying saucers make great "human interest" stories. You know the kind I mean. In Canada, for example, CBC-TV's *The National* is the major late-night news program, with Knowlton Nash (soon to be Peter Mansbridge, the guy who turned down ABC). Nash always finishes his newscast with a story, sometimes a "feature," which is typically about a family reunited after 40 years, a man who opened a restaurant for dogs, a girl who went to court to play on a college hockey team, or a host of similar topics. UFO stories usually appear here as well. American TV news is no different.

The reason for this is that UFOs are not perceived as "vital" news and can be cut from the newscast in an emergency, without bumping an important news event (such as a strike at the local brewery). Often reporters assigned to do stories on UFOs are ill-informed on the subject and may introduce more than a little bias into their reports. One newspaper editor told me that he assigned UFO stories to reporters who needed to "lighten up" after covering a heavy story like a murder trial.

Ever since Herbert Strentz's thesis on the media treatment of the subject of flying saucers, there has been ample evidence to show that media reporting is often more harmful than helpful. Strentz thought that the media were responsible for most UFO flaps, either directly or indirectly. Media reports can either encourage people to report their UFOs or exaggerate minor IFOs into major invasions by alien spacecraft.

A few years ago, when I was involved in setting up a group that was interested in receiving reports about a wide range of Fortean phenomena, an argument erupted at one of the organizational meetings. While everyone agreed that the telephone number "hotline" needed to be advertised somehow, unanimity could not be reached regarding the form of the advertising. One member insisted that posters alone would suffice, while another suggested handbills and newspaper ads. Others, including me, felt that a press release was necessary to get the widest possible circulation of the phone number. Eventually, a combination of various types of advertising was adopted.

Of course, once the telephone number was advertised, the phone rang continually for the first few weeks. But not with reports; nearly all the calls were from reporters from various news agencies across the continent. We did interviews with radio stations in towns we had never heard of, from places thousands of miles away, which was frustrating to some of us, since we were careful to say that we were interested only in local sightings. After all, we could hardly investigate sightings that were too distant (but we could receive them and pass on the information to researchers in their area). The ratio of news reporters to sighting reports was approximately 25 to one. Fortunately (or unfortunately, as you might think), after several more weeks, the number of calls dropped to nearly zero when the number and the "story" were forgotten.

When the dust had settled, we agreed that the experiment had been a logistic disaster for various reasons. Some were related to the broad scope of the group; never (I repeat *never*) mix ufologists, Sasquatch hunters and "ghostbusters" together in one group. Another reason was the clash of personalities involved; loners make poor organization members. Some members were paranoid that the media might make fools of them and refused to do interviews or even be mentioned in interviews by any group spokesman. Probably the biggest factor was the difference in opinion regarding the media profile of the group. How much did the group really "need" the media? At what point is publicity a negative influence?

Consider this: in late January 1987 Stanton Friedman was scheduled to speak at the University of Manitoba. There was little advance publicity for his talk, though at the last minute a local TV station did contact him to do a live spot on the dinner news, only hours before his scheduled talk. Station personnel picked him up from his hotel, drove him to a planetarium, and did a "remote" with him. The interviewer was a local rock star who did entertainment stories for the station, covering Tina Turner concerts, wet T-shirt contests and other relevant news items. During the interview, they showed Friedman's slides upside down and giggled about his silly hobby. At one point, one slide was part of a series of close-ups of a photograph, and a number appeared next to the image of the UFO on the screen. "Which is the UFO?" snickered the interviewer. Despite this ridiculousness, Friedman drew a large, attentive crowd to his evening lecture. Certainly, many came only after seeing him on the TV interview. It is worthwhile considering whether the interview was worth the effort.

The good news is that during his return visit to Winnipeg, Friedman did five interviews with various media, all with objective, conscientious reporters.

Unfortunately, we cannot fault the media in all cases of inaccurate reporting or biased interviews. Many self-styled UFO "experts" are frequently in the public eye, fueling the impression that all ufologists are lunatics (I hope I don't fall into this category!). At one UFO conference I attended, when it came to my contribution, I suggested we examine the definition of "UFO" and thus get a better handle on what it was we were talking about. At that point, another panel member interrupted, insisting that we already knew that "UFOs are from the planet Clarion, so let's get onto more important matters."

There was once a contactee whom I interviewed several times. She came from eastern Canada, where she headed a fair-sized group. She told me she had been aboard several spacecraft with the Space Brothers and traveled to Mars and even inside the earth. Back home, she had built a UFO-detection station and a pyramid for gathering energy rays. In some newspaper clippings she displayed, one headline read: UFO SCIENTIST HOLDS RELIGIOUS CEREMONY AT UFO LANDING SITE, under a picture of her beside a well of "healing waters" which she discovered with psychic powers. Such headlines are more frequent than we would like to think.

The reason for this is obvious: it is difficult for news media to discern an "expert" on UFOs. No one speaks for ufologists as a whole. Carl Sagan is usually chosen by the media as an ultimate authority on astronomy, though his expertise in certain astronomical subjects is not as great as others. For science fiction? Isaac Asimov, of course. Consumerism? Ralph Nader. But ufology?

A general rule for media types is that an expert on a certain topic is always a Ph.D. in his or her field. It doesn't work that way in real life, but that is how expertise is generally defined. With regard to UFOs, astronomers are in a particularly bad position. UFO = Space; therefore astronomers must be experts on UFOs. Unfortunately, though astronomers may be able to speak with authority on the distance to the Hyades or the light curve of Shelton's Supernova, their knowledge of the subject of UFOs may be sadly lacking. But because they are only on the receiving end of questions about UFOs, they are not required to know anything about ufology in general. Media require only an astronomer's opinion. This situation has caused a great quantity of confusing information to be thrust upon the public (and media). Neither the "true experts" nor the "viewed experts" appear to be listening to each other, because they say things that the other contradicts. Compound this with the typographical or reporting errors that arise once an article actually appears in the media, and the result is information chaos.

For example, in the *Cambridge UFO Research Group Newsletter*, Vol. 2, No. 26, December 1987, Bonnie Wheeler reprints an article from the *London Free Press*, October 31, 1987. The substantial article features interviews with her, Henry McKay (a MUFON rep), William Wehlau (an astronomer at a university) and Allen McNamara (a space physicist with the National Research Council). The reporter did appear to try to get some balance by having two persons from each camp

give their opinions. But the article itself shows that there is a communication gap between ufologists and scientists, without resolving the issue.

The article acknowledges a "debate" on the subject but doesn't pursue the matter. Henry McKay is quoted as saying: "Eighty-five to 87 per cent of the cases reported these days are roughage. Either there isn't enough information about them or the information is so inconsistent they can't be traced...But it's [the] last [percentage] that concerns UFO investigators." He is further paraphrased as saying that in the remaining cases, "there are enough things to indicate that [the sighting was not that of] a bright planet, aircraft landing lights or a meteor." A few paragraphs further on, Wehlau advises that "the planet Venus in daytime can be a very striking spectacle" and later tells how sundogs and light pillars can be "quite spectacular." Later in the article, McNamara is quoted as saying, "UFO-ologists [sic] say that 10 per cent of the cases investigated are unexplained, but I'm surprised the figure is not a lot higher. The information we receive is so sketchy or so vague that we can't offer any explanation and, of course, it goes into the books as being an unexplained incident."

Now, assuming they were quoted correctly, we can see some big problems with these statements. Wehlau is certainly correct in what he says about Venus and atmospheric effects, but he says nothing about those sightings that have no astronomical or atmospheric explanation. The suggestion is that all sightings can be explained that way. McNamara is also correct in describing the NRC files, but his interpretation of "unexplained" is clearly at odds with McKay's. McKay clearly says that cases which are "sketchy" or "vague" are roughage, while to McNamara they are the only unexplained UFO reports. This isn't even a matter of disagreement. McNamara clearly knows little if anything about McKay's investigation procedures. (However, during one of my visits to Toronto, I was approached by one ufologist who wanted me to sit along the lakefront with his group and watch the UFOs fly by throughout the night. In plain view of a private airport, I wondered if his investigation procedures were more like those McNamara had in mind.)

On another occasion, both Allen Hynek and a scientist from the National Research Council of Canada were in Winnipeg in the late 1970s, to lecture on UFOs to a Teachers' Society meeting. Several hundred people crammed a hall to listen to Hynek's talk, while only a fraction attended the other's lecture. (This was certainly fuel for CSICOP's claim that "popularizers" get all the attention while critics are ignored.) Both of the speakers discussed landing traces, with Hynek emphasizing the positive and the NRC rep emphasizing the negative aspects of the phenomena with respect to their being "real" landing traces. The NRC spokesman at one point in his talk showed a slide of fairy rings (mushrooms) and said that many UFO landing traces are explained as such. At that time, there had been an interesting series of traces found near a small

Manitoba town, and he was asked whether these traces were fairy rings. He replied, "Yes, most probably." What was remarkable was that he had never investigated the traces, yet was giving his professional opinion about them at a major conference with the media in attendance. Several people, including ufologists Gary Lanham, Brian James and me, did go to examine the traces and speak with the local residents and the RCMP. Agricultural scientists also examined the site. The consensus was that the ring traces were not fairy rings. Fairy rings are quite different from most alleged UFO landing traces that I have been shown, and they take a number of years to achieve any size worth mentioning. But agriculture is not usually covered in cosmology courses in college, so it is not reasonable to expect that an astronomer would know details about the life cycle of the fairy ring mushroom.

Then there's misquotation, apart from those errors that are actually said. I was recently interviewed by a local newspaper, and in a description of the apparent speed of the object tracked on radar during the Canadian Airlines UFO case of 1987, I pointed out that the speed was thought to be in excess of the speed of sound, which is about 700 miles per hour. I was quoted as saying that "the speed of sound is 700 km an hour." And of the infamous Michalak case, which I have researched and written of several times: "Michalak saw two standard flying saucers, about 35 feet in diameter, and when he tried to communicate with the voices he heard, they took off and left him with second degree radiation burns." The text bears a certain vague resemblance to what I recall saying, though it is a condensation of the entire Michalak case in one sentence. Things are a bit out of context, and I'm sure I did not say the burns were from radiation, but as telephone interviews go, it was close to the facts (emphasis on "close").

There do appear to be some ways of getting around the problems associated with media communications. Ufologists could, for example, be as careful as police in their statements about any reported UFO. Legal advisers are careful to use "alleged crime" in their description of an "altercation." Ufologists could be very cautious and call a sighting report an "alleged UFO," though the witnesses involved might not like the implication that they were lying. A press release could speak of a "supposed landing trace left by the allegedly observed UFO." UFO witnesses, unfortunately, are often regarded as "guilty of errors" until proven otherwise. And the ridicule curtain that some ufologists speak of certainly tags witnesses guilty of some psychiatric affliction if they appear in the media.

Written reports or press releases, rather than on-the-spot interviews which can be taken out of context, should be the preferred method of communicating with terrestrial intelligences. Getting a good proofreader before the actual release is a logical idea as well.

Perhaps the best way to deal with statements by unknowledgeable "experts" is to anticipate their comments. We know that most nonufologist scientists use references to

atmospheric phenomena, astronomical objects and hallucinations to refute UFO sightings. Therefore, any ufologist worth his or her salt should emphasize that these phenomena are not UFOs and do not constitute valid UFO data, as some critics might suggest. It is also worth mentioning that most UFO critics do not investigate UFO reports themselves.

Finally, and this will be hard for some of us, don't say anything stupid. My files contain a number of "unexplained" sightings, but I don't insist that they represent visits from UMMO. Critics find it easy to ridicule self-styled ufologists, especially those who infuse their statements about UFO sightings with their interpretations of the Bible, the color of aliens' skin or the propulsion system of the spacecraft. Verbal restraint might seem to make for a very conservative, dry interview, but it is from unqualified statements by earlier ufologists that critics and media developed their concept of the silly season.

One major criticism of scientists, and this is not confined to ufology, has to do with the inability to use the words "I don't know." When asked to explain why something occurred in the manner it did, a scientist will usually offer an opinion. There's a wonderful story about a famous physicist who was accosted in a hallway by an undergraduate student with a large piece of cardboard upon which was a simple line graph. The ordinate and abscissa were indefinite, and the graph showed a dark line moving diagonally up the chart. The student asked the physicist why the results of his experiment gave the presented appearance. "It is perfectly obvious," replied the distinguished professor, "that the reaction occurred precisely as predicted by theory and the energy of the particle increased with time." Puzzled, the student looked again at the chart, then turned it 90 degrees. "Sorry," he stammered, "I had the chart sideways."

No one is exempt from misquotation, typographic errors, lapses of memory, judgmental errors or the occasional foray into speculation. But because ufologists have been viewed not as experts but as religious fanatics, statements by ufologists in the media should be as succinct as possible. I have made some fair-sized errors of judgment in my own media interviews and have paid the price accordingly. Of course, bland and noncommittal statements hardly make good copy or television, and the media might find this quite boring. So the question is: Should a ufologist present the case for UFOs in a straight manner or give his or her own interpretation and opinions?

If asked as an expert, I can say with authority, "I don't know." And you can quote me on that.

MUFON meets in Lincoln

"Abductions and the Extraterrestrial Hypothesis" is the theme of this year's annual conference of the Mutual UFO Network. The conference is being held on June 24-26 at the Nebraska Center Hotel, University of Nebraska in Lincoln. Speakers include *IUR* editor Jerome Clark, Walter N. Webb, David M. Jacobs, Budd Hopkins, Bruce Maccabee, Ray Boeche, and Marge Christensen.

The current literature

by George M. Eberhart

George M. Eberhart, *IUR* contributing editor and CUFOS librarian, is compiler of the two-volume bibliography *UFOs and the Extraterrestrial Contact Movement* (1986).

Nigel Watson, *Phantom Aerial Flaps and Waves*. Magonia Magazine, John Dee Cottage, 5 James Terrace, Mortlake Churchyard, London SW14 8HB. 1987. 24p. Cost:94 pence.

This booklet provides a concise summary, with references, of various UFO events from Springheel Jack in 1830s to the Swedish ghost rockets of 1946. Some lesser-known waves are included, such as the March 1892 airship wave over Russian Poland and the Norwegian reports of 1914-1916. The question of whether the events are ufological or sociological is left open, Watson thereby hoping to inspire further research into early reports untainted by contemporary perceptions of UFOs as alien spacecraft.

A 600-page catalog of the British phantom-airship wave of 1912-1913, produced by Nigel Watson, Granville Oldroyd, and David Clarke, may be obtained from the Fund for UFO Research, Box 277, Mount Rainier, Maryland 20712.

Irena Scott, "Survey of Unidentified Aerial Phenomenon Reports in Delaware County, Ohio," *Ohio Journal of Science* 87 (1987):24-26.

Dr. Scott, a physiologist at Ohio State University, interviewed 62 persons who lived in the area of an unpublicized UFO sighting in a rural area north of Columbus. The study was conducted primarily to determine the frequency of UFO experiences in a specific locale. Thirty-one percent of those surveyed had seen apparently anomalous UFOs sometime in the previous 36 years; 17 percent reported knowing someone who had seen a UFO. Scott speculates that the increasing public acceptance of UFO phenomena might just as well be explained by widespread UFO observations as media coverage.

Judith W. Rhue and Steven Jay Lynn, "Fantasy Proneness and Psychopathology," *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology* 53(1987):327-36.

Although UFO-abduction experiences are not mentioned, this article points to one avenue of inquiry that might be taken in future abduction research. The authors subjected two groups of "fantasy prone" individuals to a battery of psychological tests and concluded that the majority were well-adjusted. The fantasizers are described as persons who are excellent hypnotic

subjects and whose mental imagery can seem "more real than real" to them, becoming confused with actual persons and events. Other notable characteristics of fantasizers: they feel nausea and anxiety while watching violence on TV and in the movies, they relive personal life experiences vividly when recalling them, they often claim psychic or mystical experiences, and sometimes they report false pregnancies or physical reactions to vivid fantasies or memories. Testing UFO abductees for fantasy proneness may shed some light on the topic.

See also Steven Jay Lynn and Judith W. Rhue, "The Fantasy-Prone Person: Hypnosis, Imagination, and Creativity," *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology* 51 (1986):404-408; and S.C. Wilson and T.X. Barber, "The Fantasy-Prone Personality: Implications for Understanding Imagery, Hypnosis, and Parapsychological Phenomena," in A.A. Sheikh, ed., *Imagery: Current Theory, Research, and Application* (New York: Wiley, 1983), pp. 340-90.

Al Frickey [pseud.], "Stealth—and Beyond," *Gung-Ho: The Magazine for the International Military Man* 8 (February 1988): 37-43.

In addition to some interesting information on new aircraft that are silent, invisible to radar, and undetectable in the infrared, this article contains a curious endnote which claims there has been for several years an Alien Technology Center at Nellis AFB in Nevada where UFO "equipment and personnel" have been studied to help develop star wars and other advanced weaponry. Force-field-, flying-saucer-, and gravity-drive systems are also rumored to have gone beyond the blueprint stage.

True, nothing but rumor, yet from a surprising source.

Vicente-Juan Ballester Olmos and Juan A. Fernandez Peris, *Enciclopedia de los encuentros cercanos con OVNI's*. Barcelona, Spain: Plaza y Janes Editores, March 1987. 383p.

Here is another excellent Spanish-language book that cries out for an English translation. It's not a true encyclopedia as you might suspect, but a casebook of carefully chosen Iberian UFO cases. Reports are grouped by their most prominent characteristics: unusual luminous properties, physical traces, EM effects, physiological effects, car chases, occupant cases, and ball-lightning or "earthlight" cases. The authors include a chapter on IFOs and an appendix which chronicles the actions of the Spanish government with regard to UFOs through 1985.

Time-Life Books, *The UFO Phenomenon*. Alexandria, Virginia: Time-Life Books, 1987. 160p.

Excellent photographs and artwork are the highlight of this

entry in Time-Life's "Mysteries of the Unknown" series. This is definitely a coffee-table book, but credit must go to Time-Life's research team for talking with the right people in ufology. Overall, a commendable effort which provides a balanced introduction to the topic for readers approaching the subject for the first time.

Jon Klimo, *Channeling: Investigations on Receiving Information from Paranormal Sources*. Los Angeles: Jeremy P. Tarcher, 1987. 384p.

Although sympathetic to channelers, Klimo's intelligent examination of paranormal mediums and messages provides a much-needed historical perspective on the topic and summarizes the major hypotheses—mystical, psychological, and physical—that attempt to account for it. Scientists and skeptics are quoted as liberally as the channelers themselves. Whether we mind it or not, ufologists are more and more likely to run into New Age philosophy which has managed to blur the dividing line between the UFO phenomenon and psychic messages from Space Brothers, and it helps to keep apprised of developments on the other side, as it were. Of particular interest to UFO historians is Klimo's coverage of modern contactees from George Adamski to Ruth Norman.

Klimo keeps his mind open and academic, never descending into the "gee whizardry" characteristic of other writers such as Kathryn Ridall, "Ph.D.," in *Channeling: How to Reach Out to Your Spirit Guides* (New York: Bantam, 1988). The difference in tone of these two similarly titled works can be seen in their chapter subheads: "Hypnosis, Trance, and Cognitive Psychology" and "Correlation with Unhappy Childhood" (Klimo); "Sitting with Your Vase" and "Writing Your Invocation" (Ridall).

Jenny Randles, *The UFO Conspiracy: The First Forty Years*. Poole, Dorset, England: Blandford Press, 1987. Distributed in the U.S. by Sterling Publishing Co., New York. 244p.

Here is another laudable effort from one of British ufology's leading lights. This time the focus is on worldwide governmental deception in dealing with the UFO phenomenon. Although there is not a preponderance of new material in this volume, Randles' engaging style and outspokenness on official secrecy make up for the familiarity. The emphasis on worldwide attitudes and cases highlights the global nature of ufology for us North Americans who cannot easily get information on overseas events. One section of *The UFO Conspiracy* supplements her previous book, *UFO Reality*, by examining the best physical evidence for UFOs.

Randles' only excursion into overenthusiasm is her contention that there is a massive UFO "education program" conducted at the instigation of various governments and designed to enlighten the public about alien visitations. Invoking the movie *Close Encounters of the Third Kind* as part of that official debriefing seems inconsistent with the way the Hollywood entertainment industry works.

Brad Steiger, *The Fellowship: Spiritual Contact Between Humans and Outer Space Beings*. New York: Doubleday, 1988. 179p.

One thing you can say about Steiger's contactee books—at least he doesn't bore the reader with incredibly tedious monologues from channeled space aliens; instead, he humanely summarizes them. *The Fellowship* recounts the New Age adventures of Renaissance man and contactee Fred Bell, of Laguna Beach, California. Bell claims to be tuned into the same Pleiadean entities as Switzerland's Billy Meier, Semjase in particular. Steiger goes on and on with his usual themes of ancient astronauts, intergalactic plans for a New Civilization, Atlantis, and space-age religion, but this time he mixes in Nazi UFOs, alchemy, and Egyptian mystery schools—just to be controversial, I suppose. Great stuff if you're a channeler, but pretty much lumpy gravy for meat-and-potatoes ufologists.

William K. Hartmann and Ron Miller, *Cycles of Fire: Stars, Galaxies and the Wonder of Deep Space*. Original artwork by Hartmann, Miller, Pamela Lee, and Tom Miller. New York: Workman, October 1987. 189p.

This beautifully illustrated introduction to astrophysics is the third volume in the authors' series of books on outer space. The previous titles, *The Grand Tour* and *Out of the Cradle*, brought to life our solar system and its potential for space exploration. *Cycles of Fire* takes us to the very edge of the known universe so that we can stand on imaginary planets and view the red giant Antares, a supernova up close, or double rainbows refracting the light from a double star.

Extraterrestrial intelligence and our search for it are briefly reviewed, along with several paragraphs on UFOs (as might be expected from former Condon Committee investigator Hartmann and *IUR* staff artist Miller). Other fascinating chapters explore extrasolar planetary systems, neutron stars and black holes, quasars, and active galactic nuclei. It's better than being there!

Coral Lorenzen — *continued from page 11*

As the health of both the Lorenzens deteriorated in the early 1980s, the *Bulletin* was published infrequently and the few issues that did appear lacked the focus, clarity and editorial care that had characterized the periodical in happier days. Rumors circulated about APRO's imminent demise, especially following Jim's death from cancer in August 1986, but the organization survived, if only in name, until shortly after Mrs. Lorenzen's death. It was the oldest UFO group in America.

Coral and Jim Lorenzen were pioneers of serious UFO study. They and APRO will always hold an honored place in the history of ufology. They will be missed. — *Jerome Clark*

Letters

To the editor:

I read, with interest, Chris Rutkowski's article "Burned by a UFO? The Story of a Bungled Investigation," dealing with the Falcon Lake incident, in the November/December 1987 issue of *IUR*. At first, it was my inclination to ignore the mistakes, misunderstandings and insinuations in the article. But I believe *IUR* to be one of the top UFO publications in the world and because I knew and respected Allen Hynek for many years, I decided I would respond. A little background first:

I received a phone call from Rutkowski in which he said an article dealing with Falcon Lake had been accepted for publication by *IUR*. He went on to say that he had originally called the piece "Over the Beaver Dam" but that it had been retitled by someone in your editorial department. Unfortunately I was not asked to see the original article before it was published. If I had, I could have provided more information. I have numbered the passages I refer to in the following pages. I hope this additional information is of some use to you.

1. This account is essentially correct. Stephen Michalak described the objects as "cigar-shaped objects with humps on them." As they descended they became "more oval-shaped."

2. The purple light coming from the slits of the UFO forced Michalak to turn his eyes away and caused the red afterimages; he did not flip the green filters down over his welding goggles until later.

3. When he was close enough to touch the UFO, he was standing directly in front of the "hatch." Because the light from the hatch was extremely bright, he was forced to flip down the filter on his goggles. He then looked in and saw the lights. He also noted the wall thickness (18 to 20 inches).

4. This is the Trans Canada Highway #1. During his walk out Michalak was sick several more times, his vision dimmed and he had spots in front of eyes. He came out on the highway about a mile from his motel, he spotted an RCMP car, he flagged it down. When the constable approached, Michalak warned him back and said he was sick. The officer left and Michalak continued on his way. The motel was destroyed a few years ago and no longer exists.

5. At this time my position at the Manitoba Planetarium was artist/photographer/researcher. I am now a planetarium producer/curator. I also head the Manitoba Center for UFO Studies formed in 1977 at the planetarium.

6. CAPRO was formed in November 1967 by Brian Cannon, me and two others. Barry Thompson was liaison between CAPRO and the American APRO. He was also APRO's representation for central and eastern Canada; he was never elected an officer of CAPRO.

The group disbanded not from "personality conflicts," as Rutkowski has it, but for other reasons. Cannon had decided to become an independent UFO investigator and was planning to leave the city. UFO activity had decreased markedly and as a consequence, membership declined. As a last-ditch effort, CAPRO was taken over by another member, but it was terminal and CAPRO died. What remained of the files were turned over to me. I was able to reclaim a portion of the files, mostly letters. These were written mostly by Cannon and Thompson. They dealt primarily with the Michalak case.

7. I have a letter dated July 12, 1968, from the National Research Council of Canada. It is to Michalak c/o Osnova Publications at the address Rutkowski went to. It was forwarded to Michalak.

8. I was part of the investigation. I have kept in touch with the Michalaks over the years. I would say I have a little more than a "working knowledge" of this case.

9. The Manitoba Planetarium is a division of the Manitoba Museum of Man and Nature. The van in question was well used, not abused. We have to comply with Canadian vehicle codes and laws.

10. There were no geese on the pond when we took Rutkowski to the site. The pond was almost dry. The site of Michalak's incident was not adjacent to the beaver dam; it was further north where the beaver creek met another creek. It was around the corner from here that the event took place, out of sight.

11. You can see the fire tower from the beaver dam, but not from the "landing" site. There is dense forest made up of mature spruce, oak, poplar and heavy undergrowth, between the site and fire tower. There are other fire towers spaced at regular distances throughout this vast area. The person on watch was interviewed. He said he saw nothing unusual.

12. I have on file the analysis done at the University of Manitoba, also the name of the person who did the work. Also on file are the results of APRO's analysis as well as those of the Atomic Energy of Canada Ltd. dated June 22, 1968, and August 14, 1968, respectively. An incident report from Canadian Forces Base, Winnipeg, included analysis of samples sent by RCMP to National Health and Welfare, Canada. It states a radiation value of .3 microcurries from a radium source and was considered a possible health hazard.

13. The radium-dial theory came from a document originating from C.F. Base Winnipeg, dated May 22, 1968. It compared the reading of the metal fragments, found on the site and taken with a civilian geiger counter, to be the same level as that found on the dial face of a service wrist watch. The same counter was used.

14. Rutkowski wrote that the finger was pointed at Gerald Hart. When Michalak found the metal pieces, it was not Hart who was with him. I have on file a letter dated June 29, 1968, to the late Dr. Hynek. The letter names the person, a structural engineer, with Michalak.

Incidentally, Allen Hynek was kept informed of the

Michalak affair. He was in Winnipeg from September 6 to September 7, 1968. He talked with Michalak and the doctors responsible for treating Michalak.

15. Rutkowski states that Cannon had John Magor contact Dr. Berthold Schwarz to inquire of the Mayo Clinic's files. In fact, it was John Keel who contacted Schwarz. In a letter dated April 10, 1969, Keel said that he had imposed upon Schwarz to write to a friend of his at the clinic, a Dr. Maurice J. Barry, Jr., in the psychiatric division of the Mayo Clinic.

The "sinister disappearance" of these files makes good reading but does not reflect the truth. When I present the Michalak story to audiences in lectures and shows, I do it in a professional manner with no histrionics. Until recently, I did not know what happened to the Mayo files and I would say so. Rutkowski, for whatever reason, did not inform me of his findings in this matter.

16. I cannot answer the questions dealing with the motel or the RCMP constable. I was told the bus driver was contacted but remembered nothing unusual. This is not surprising. I am familiar with this area and the bus route. Michalak said he boarded the bus and went to the back where he "drifted in and out of sleep." There was absolutely no reason for the bus driver to take notice of him.

17. A University of Manitoba psychologist evaluated Michalak for the clinical hypnotist. The names are on file and reference is made to them in a letter I have on file. It was written by Cannon to the late Jim Lorenzen of APRO.

The "hostile fellow" with Michalak was Thompson who was protective of Michalak. The hypnosis was not done by a local newspaper reporter.

18. Rutkowski is referring to Cannon, who was a cadet at the Regina RCMP college. The story is pure bunk. I know the reason for Cannon's leaving the college but it is a personal matter.

I hope that this helps to clear up some of the questions Rutkowski raised in his article.

*Edward M. Barker
Producer, Manitoba Planetarium
Manitoba Museum of Man and Nature
Winnipeg*

To the editor:

In his article "The Abduction of Sammy Desmond" (July/August 1987 *IUR*) D. Scott Rogo wonders why UFO beings might subject a male human to the same abdominal intrusion as a female. I should call the attention of interested readers to an article in the December 1987 issue of *Scientific American* entitled "Courtship in Unisexual Lizards: A Model for Brain Evolution."

A synopsis of this article published in the index reads as follows: "In several species of whiptail lizards there are no males; reproduction is parthenogenetic. Some females nonethe-

less assume the role of males, engaging in courtship and pseudo copulation. It appears that in these species the brain can give rise to both male and female behavior regardless of an individual's biological sex."

It is probably true that human beings do not have the last word on sexuality. Our rigid division of the cosmos into "male" and "female" beings may be naive.

*Eugenia Macer-Story
Woodstock, New York*

To the editor:

In "What They're Doing to Us" (September/October 1987 *IUR*), Budd Hopkins proposes two alternatives regarding the aliens' experiments on abductees. I find it difficult to stop at either one.

Why would the aliens be considered an amoral race simply because they have the audacity to perform scientific experiments on us, the "victims," and why would an understanding of human psychology necessarily stop them? Does the fact that we consider ourselves a merciful, humane (!) race stop our scientists from experimenting on animals for the good of mankind? (Surely they know they are frightening and hurting the poor things!) What about the experiments on humans during the war; in prisons (without the prisoners' consent); and drug tests in the military without the victims' knowledge? How do we know the aliens don't have groups protesting such experiments, similar to ours? How can we hope for evidence that such groups might exist when we are not even sure that the aliens exist?

We are just barely beginning to wake up to the possibility of alien visitations. We must not begin to label them until we are able to learn much more, then compare our actions to theirs. Why should we expect them to be any more compassionate towards us than we are towards other species (and our own) in our very own backyard? How can we expect them to stop the evil in our society when most of the world stood by, for far too long doing nothing, while one of Earth's nations cruelly killed off millions of Jews?

If we were advanced enough to send scientists to a planet populated with beings similar to our alleged abductors, I doubt that these scientists would take it upon themselves to interfere with the natives' goings-on, at least not until such a course of action was considered safe. They would probably have orders to just gather information to the best of their ability and leave. A few more insightful individuals might help out here and there in small proportions—exactly to the extent that the aliens are supposedly helping here. Why should we expect aliens to be all-powerful, all-knowledgeable "gods" any more than we are?

*Eve D. Newey
Bermuda Dunes, California*

EDITORIAL — *continued from page 3*

who have disagreed with our negative assessment of the Gulf Breeze episode have told us, in effect, that we had no right to express our point of view, even as they were freely expressing theirs. (Presumably they would have been perfectly content if we had expressed a point of view that agreed with theirs.) They have complained about the "damage" we are supposed to have done and some have declared that CUFOS has embarked on a "feud" with the MUFON leadership.

Both of these charges are nonsense. If ufology were to eschew the vigorous internal criticism that has long characterized its approach to UFO inquiry, it would be a religious movement. It would also be akin to the debunking movement, in which such in-house skeptical scrutiny is all but nonexistent (demonstrating that the movement, whatever its pretensions to the contrary, is not scientific but polemical and even, in its most extreme expression, theological).

Ufologists should also know the history of their subject and respect its lessons. One major reason most of us have concluded that UFOs are real and anomalous is that the phenomena manifest in patterns, deviations from which almost invariably prove suspect upon investigation. If these patterns did not exist, the assertion that the "UFO phenomenon" is just a collection of random fantasies, lies and misobservations would be hard to refute. "Ufology" would be a pointless exercise because it would have nothing to study; if it existed at all, it would be as a minor discipline peopled by students of perceptual and psychological quirks.

The only "pattern" to which Gulf Breeze conforms is that set by Adamski, Howard Menger and Billy Meier. Gulf Breeze's supporters have yet to show us otherwise. One suspects, sadly, that if Ed had claimed to be meeting Space Brothers instead of *Communion*-style humanoids, his claims would have been recognized immediately for what they are: nothing with which we ought to be concerning ourselves. — *Jerome Clark*

A note to the committed —

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or something similar, unless two separate sets of photographs, one submitted anonymously, are attributed to Ed as well." Incredibly, we are being asked to take as evidence *anonymous* photographs as support for a questionable case. The mind boggles. I would have thought it was obvious that UFO investigation cannot use anonymous evidence for any reason. How can an investigation of such evidence proceed?

Robert Boyd tells us that the "Ultimate Prank" to be pulled

off by Ed did not refer to a proposed high school trick, despite what Andrus claims. And while it is true that the fellow who supplied the information is not above some suspicion himself, it is equally true that he gave the MUFON team the names of several other individuals who could support his claims. To our knowledge, none of this potentially damaging evidence has been checked by Ware and Flannigan. And if they have attempted to do so, why no mention of it in the three reports published by MUFON?

Our knowledge of UFO literature and history was one factor that led us to make a public statement. Only disregard for past events would make one blind to the parallels between this case and classic hoaxes. Does this make it a hoax? No, but it surely should make one cautious when presenting claims about Gulf Breeze. Dredging up the theories of Deardorff and Vallee (has not Vallee's later work been sufficiently discredited?) as support for a "strategy" behind the UFO phenomenon is putting speculation before evidence. We should instead use past investigations of actual cases as our guide, not abstract theories.

Let me close by reiterating that the role of the onsite investigators has been most troubling in this whole affair. They rejected Boyd's attempts to put some balance in their work; they have spoken prematurely about the event on several occasions; they have not followed up on all the evidence pointing to a hoax, and they hardly now correspond privately about the case at all. Why Ware and Flannigan acted in this manner is unclear to me, but the quality of the investigation was what initially made us uneasy.

I suppose this statement will not be CUFOS' last word on Gulf Breeze, though it would be pleasant to think it so. Rhetoric, anecdotes and "preliminary reports" do not an investigation make. I look forward to studying the complete account of the Gulf Breeze affair.

Itinerary for John P. Timmerman and the CUFOS UFO photo exhibit

June 16-19:

CUFOS UFO Photo Exhibit on public display at Arnot Mall, Horseheads, New York.

June 24-26:

CUFOS UFO Photo Exhibit on public display at Neil Armstrong Space Museum, Wapakoneta, Ohio.

July 9-10:

Timmerman speaks at Horizon Seminar and CUFOS UFO Photo Exhibit on public display, Reno, Nevada.



This artist's rendition of a widely-circulated mid-1950s hoax photograph of obscure origin shows a "flying cup" reminiscent of the object that figures in the controversial Gulf Breeze, Florida, episode.